

Jack Schwanewede

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EDUCATION

Davidson College

Davidson, NC

Bachelor of Science, Major in Cognitive Science, Minor in Data Science

May 2026

- GPA: 3.96, *magna cum laude*
- Relevant Coursework: Data Visualization, Machine Learning, Mathematical Modeling, Database Programming, Deep Learning, Research Design & Statistics, Data Structures, Linear Algebra, Cognitive Psychology, Perception & Attention

University College London

London, UK

Psychology Affiliate Student

September - December 2024

- Relevant Coursework: Computational Cognitive Neuroscience, Brain and Behaviour, Solomon Visual Neuroscience Lab

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Davidson Research in Immersive Virtual Environments

Davidson, NC

Computer Science / Virtual Reality Researcher, Laboratory of Tabitha Peck, PhD

May 2024 - Present

- Develop and program C# and Unity experiments to study cognition, attention, and mapping in Virtual and Mixed Reality
- Conduct experiments, recruit and run participants (200+), and analyze results in R
- Author manuscripts and present results at international conferences, 2 published in *IEEE VR* and 1 under review at *ISMAR*

John Crosland Jr. Center for Teaching & Learning - Data CATS

Davidson, NC

Consultant at Data Consulting, Analytics, Tutoring Services

August 2025 - May 2026

- Tutored students and advised faculty in data science, computer science, economics, and related technical topics
- Debugged and optimized statistical analyses in R, Python, SQL, HTML, and more

'Cats Stats Sports Analytics

Davidson, NC

Data Engineer

June 2025 - May 2026

- Analyzed team statistics for Davidson's Division I women's field hockey team, provided data-driven recommendations to staff
- Built an interactive HTML/CSS/JavaScript web app to track corner plays and support in-game strategy
- Visualized team scholarship data in infographic presented at capital campaign to advocate for increased funding and support

Davidson VGSocLab (Video Game Sociology Lab)

Davidson, NC

Data Engineer and Research Adviser, Laboratory of Jeremy Brenner-Levoy, PhD

May 2025 - April 2026

- Scraped, cleaned, and analyzed video game character data in Python and Beautiful Soup to build a research dataset
- Created Machine Learning classifier models to investigate character stat differences and predict demographics, presented results at *Southern Sociological Society*

INVOLVEMENT / ACTIVITIES

Davidson College Games Club

Davidson, NC

Vice President and Social Chair

January 2024 - May 2026

- Organized and led social events for club of 300+ members, including board, card, and video games to strengthen community
- Co-hosted an interview with MatPat (Game Theory) in front of 400 attendees

WALT 1610 Radio

Davidson, NC

Bass Guitarist and Band Coordinator

April 2023 - May 2026

- Performed regularly in multiple student bands, rehearse weekly
- Organized and communicated with student organizations to run music-related social events

Davidson College Symphony Orchestra

Davidson, NC

Principal Double Bassist

August 2022 - May 2026

- Served as principal double bassist, leading the bass section in rehearsals and performances
- Performed in 10+ concerts annually, and maintained regular rehearsal and practice commitments

SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, Java, C#, HTML, CSS, JavaScript,
- **Data/ML:** R, SQL, pandas, NumPy, PyTorch, Stata, Beautiful Soup
- **Tools:** Unity, Blender, LaTeX, WordPress
- **Language:** Spanish (Conversational)

PUBLICATIONS

- **J. A. Schwanewede**, Y. Itoh and T. C. Peck, "A Cross-Cultural Study: The Impact of Lab Clutter on Performance and Movement in AR and VR," Under Review at *IEEE International Symposium on Mixed and Augmented Reality 2026*.
- **J. A. Schwanewede**, A. D. Bond and T. C. Peck, "Clean Up Your Lab: The Impact of Technology Clutter and Replica Environments on Cognitive Performance," Accepted at *IEEE Virtual Reality 2026*.
- **J. A. Schwanewede**, A. A. Guth and T. C. Peck, "The Impact of Environment Design Bias on Working Memory," in *IEEE Transactions on Visualization and Computer Graphics*, vol. 31, no. 5, pp. 2933-2942, May 2025.

PRESENTATIONS

- **J. Schwanewede**, H. Desai and J. Brenner-Levoy, "A Machine Learning Approach to Predicting Video Game Character Demographics Based on Stat Attributes," presented at *Southern Sociological Society*, Jacksonville, Florida, April 2026.
- **J. A. Schwanewede**, A. D. Bond and T.C. Peck, "Clean Up Your Lab: The Impact of Technology Clutter and Replica Environments on Cognitive Performance," presented at *IEEE Virtual Reality 2026*, Daegu, South Korea, March 2026.
- **J. Schwanewede**, "Design Bias in VR: Impact of Real/Virtual Spaces on Attention and Cognition," presented at Davidson Math/Computer Science Coffee Talk, Davidson, NC, Sep. 2025.
- **J. A. Schwanewede**, A. D. Bond and T. C. Peck, "Attention, Cognition, and Learning in Real and Virtual Spaces," presented at Davidson College Fall Research and Creative Works Symposium, Davidson, NC, Sep. 2025.
- **J. A. Schwanewede**, A. A. Guth and T. C. Peck, "The Impact of Environment Design Bias on Working Memory," presented at *IEEE Virtual Reality 2025*, Saint-Malo, France, March 2025.
- E. Anglin, M. Hamer, **J. Schwanewede**, I. Thomas and C. Whelchel, "Impact of Induced Mood on Emotion Recognition and Reaction Time for 'Faces' in Inanimate Objects (Face Pareidolia)," presented at Davidson College Verna Miller Case Symposium, Davidson, NC, May 2025.

AWARDS/HONORS

- **Frontis W. Johnston Award - High Honors in Interdisciplinary Studies / Cognitive Science (2026)**
- **Phi Beta Kappa (2026)**
- **Dean Rusk International Studies Grant (2025)** - funded VR research experiment at the Institute of Science Tokyo, Japan
- **Davidson Research Initiative Grant (2025)** - summer funding for conducting and developing VR experiment